



Setup Guide: AI Email Triage & Routing Agent

A step-by-step guide to get you up and running.

Introduction

Is your inbox a bottleneck? This AI agent reads, classifies, and routes every new Gmail message to the right person or department—instantly. Stop manually forwarding emails and never miss a hot lead again. This guide will walk you through deploying your automated inbox manager in under 5 minutes.

Prerequisites

Before you begin, please ensure you have the following:

- ✓ **Active Gmail Account**

The email account you want to automate.

✓ OpenAI API Key

Find this in your [OpenAI account settings](#) under the 'API Keys' section.

✓ Slack Workspace Credentials

Access to a Slack workspace where you can receive notifications.

Node-by-Node Setup Guide

Your workflow is composed of several connected nodes. Here's how to configure the essential ones that require your credentials.

1. Gmail (Trigger & Actions)



Gmail Trigger & Gmail Send/Label Nodes

Role: *Kicks off the workflow for each new email, applies labels, and forwards messages.*

These nodes require access to your Google account. You will likely be prompted to connect your account when you first import the workflow.

Connecting Your Gmail Account:

1. In your n8n workflow, click on the [Gmail Trigger](#) node.
2. Under the 'Credential' field, click 'Create New'.
3. A new browser window will open. Follow the on-screen instructions to sign in to your Google account and grant n8n permission.
4. Once connected, your credential will be saved. You can select this same credential for all other Gmail nodes in the workflow (e.g., [Add Label](#), [Gmail](#) for forwarding).
5. In the forwarding nodes, make sure to update the **To** field with the correct team/department email addresses.

2. OpenAI (Analysis & Classification)



OpenAI Chat Model & Text Classifier Nodes

Role: This is the "brain" of the operation. It reads the email content and intelligently classifies it into categories like Sales, Support, etc.

These nodes use your OpenAI API key to perform the analysis.

Connecting Your OpenAI Account:

1. First, get your API key from the [OpenAI API Keys page](#). Click "Create new secret key".
2. Copy the key immediately. You will not be able to see it again.
3. In your n8n workflow, click on an OpenAI node (e.g., [Text Classifier](#)).
4. Under the 'Credential' field, click 'Create New'.
5. Give your credential a name (e.g., "My OpenAI Key").
6. Paste your copied API key into the 'API Key' field.
7. Click 'Save'. You can now select this credential for all OpenAI nodes.

Configuration Note: The prompt within the OpenAI node has been pre-configured to classify emails. You can customize this prompt if you want to add or change classification categories.

3. If (Conditional Routing)



If Node

Role: Acts as a traffic controller. Based on the category provided by OpenAI, this node directs the email to the correct path for labeling and forwarding.

No credentials are required for this node.

Configuration Note: You should inspect the [If](#) node to see how it routes different categories. If you modified the categories in the OpenAI node, you must update the conditions in the [If](#) node to match.

4. Slack (Notifications)



Slack

Slack Nodes

Role: Sends real-time alerts to your team's Slack channels, ensuring fast response times to important emails.

These nodes require a connection to your Slack workspace.

Connecting Your Slack Account:

1. In your n8n workflow, click on a `Slack` node.
2. Under the 'Credential' field, click 'Create New'.
3. Follow the on-screen instructions. A new window will pop up asking you to authorize n8n to access your Slack workspace.
4. Once you approve, the connection is complete.
5. In the node settings, specify the **Channel** you want to post to (e.g., `#sales-leads` or `#support-tickets`) and customize the message text.

Workflow Import & Activation

With your credentials ready, you can now import and activate the workflow.

1. Download the workflow `.json` file provided to you.
2. In your n8n instance, click on **Workflows**, then click the **Add Workflow** button.
3. Select **Import from file** and choose the `.json` file you just downloaded.
4. The workflow will load on your canvas. Review the nodes to ensure your newly created credentials are selected.
5. When you are ready, click the **Active** toggle at the top right of the screen.

Congratulations!

Your AI Email Triage & Routing Agent is now live! It will automatically process every new email, saving you time and ensuring no opportunity is missed. If you run into any issues, please reach out to our support team at support@astrawave.com.